

Capital Plan

Funding every project without another failed bond

Town of Swanzey, NH · PublicLogic VAULT · June 2026

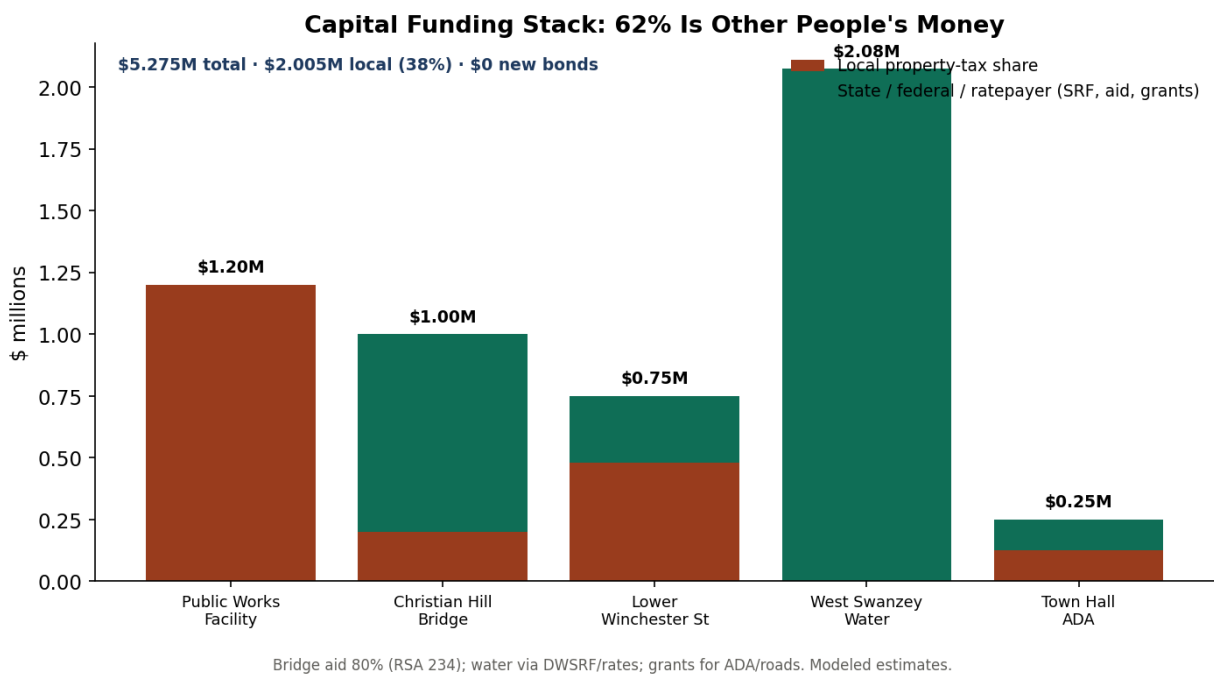
The problem

Swanzey can't borrow. Facility bonds win majorities but die at the 3/5 wall — the public works facility failed at 3/5 in both 2024 and 2026. The bridge, a street, the water system, and Town Hall accessibility all wait behind it.

The one idea: restructure the money

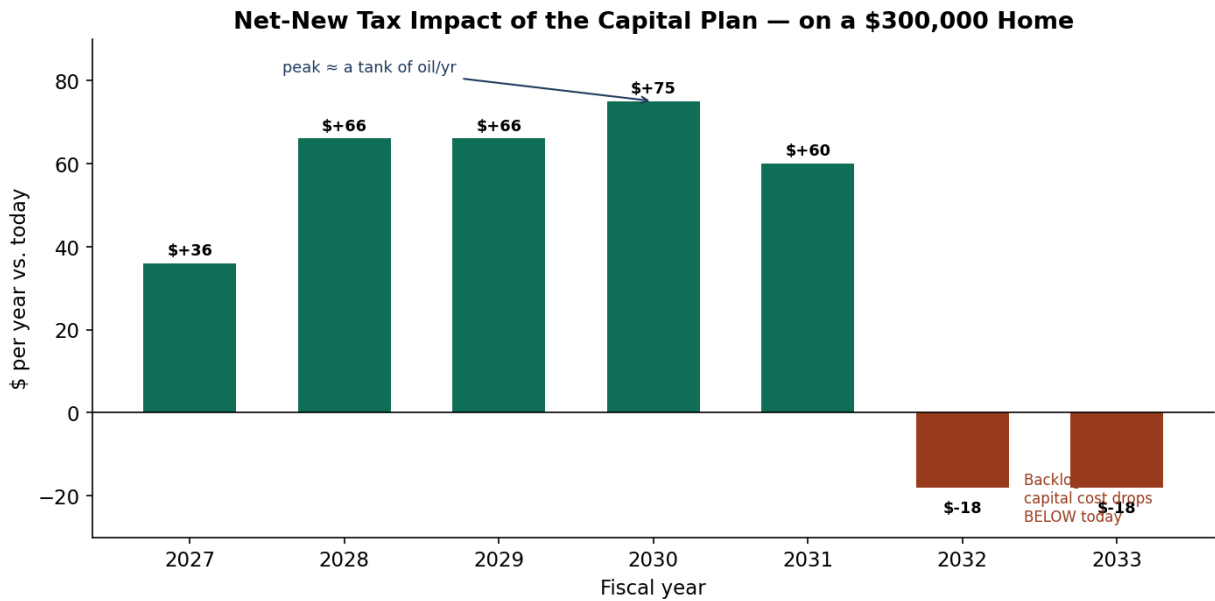
- **Make other people pay first** — bridge aid 80% (RSA 234); water via NHDES DWSRF (1% loan repaid by rates + grants + principal forgiveness); block grants & CDBG for the street and ADA work.
- **Save instead of borrow** — a bond needs 3/5; a capital reserve (RSA 35) needs a simple majority. Pay cash.
- **Smooth it out** — phase deposits so the tax impact peaks small, then drops below today's.

62% is other people's money



Of ~\$5.275M in needs, only ~\$2.005M (38%) is local — majority-vote reserves, zero new bonds.

What it costs a \$300,000 home



Majority-vote reserves + state aid; no 3/5 bonds. Modeled; confirm with town valuation & DRA.

Peak ≈ \$75/year; by 2032 the backlog is cleared and the capital burden falls below today's.

Already underway — the record validates it

In 2025 voters acquired the West Swanzey water system (RSA 38:4), created a TIF district, and funded a study expecting '100% principal forgiveness' from the DWSRF. The town has already started financing capital this way; extend the discipline to the facility, bridge, street, and ADA projects.

Recommendation

Adopt a six-year CIP built on majority-vote capital reserve funds; pursue 80% bridge aid and DWSRF water financing; build the public works facility pay-go by 2031 — no bond, no 3/5 vote.

Funding mechanics & statutory shares are real (RSA 234/35/38, NHDES DWSRF); project costs and the tax glide are planning estimates [M] — confirm with engineering, NHDOT/NHDES, and DRA.